THE PRICE OF DAWN — D100 CHARACTER & PARTY GROUNDING TABLE

Table Icebreakers & RP Anchors · Roll 1d100 before the session, during rests, or at campfires

I. CAMPFIRE, HABITS & REST (01–10)

01. **[NIGHT WATCH]** When you take your turn on watch while the others sleep, how do you keep yourself awake in the cold silence?

02. **[SLEEP QUIRKS]** Are you a silent sleeper who barely moves, or do you snore loudly, toss and turn, or mumble in your sleep?

03. **[WAKING UP]** What does your character look and act like in the first ten minutes after waking up? Grumpy, energetic, or dead to the world?

04. **[CAMPFIRE HABIT]** Around a fire or stove, what is your habitual idle task: whittling wood, polishing steel, tending the coals, or cleaning boots?

05. **[BLANKETS]** In the freezing chill of the city, do you sleep wrapped in every blanket you own, or are you stubbornly tough against the cold?

06. **[PERSONAL TRINKET]** What small, seemingly useless trinket or token do you keep in your pocket that you habitually fiddle with when thinking?

07. **[WRITING & NOTES]** Do you keep a written journal, tally marks on your belt, a sketchbook, or do you keep everything locked in your head?

08. **[MORNING BREW]** What is your morning beverage of choice before you can face the day: strong black tea, hot chicory, spiced ale, or boiled water?

09. **[NIGHTMARES]** When you have a bad dream, is it about a past failure, a terrifying monster you faced, or being left behind in the dark?

10. **[HYGIENE]** How meticulous are you about personal cleanliness on the road: fresh-scented and groomed, or proudly grimy and smelling of campfire?

II. THE PARTY & COMPANION BONDS (11–20)

11. **[FIRST IMPRESSION]** Think of another player's character. What was your very first impression of them, and how has that opinion changed since?

12. **[COMBAT TRUST]** Which companion would you want guarding your back if you were cornered in a dark alley by five armed enemies?

13. **[PET PEEVE]** What is one minor, harmless habit of another party member that secretly drives you crazy on long journeys?

14. **[SECRET ADMIRATION]** Which companion's fighting style, magic, or silver tongue do you secretly find the most impressive to watch?

15. **[THE COMFORTER]** When you are visibly shaken or exhausted after a brutal fight, which companion do you feel most comfortable talking to?

16. **[INSIDE JOKE]** What is a funny mishap, ridiculous failure, or running joke the party shares that always brings a smirk to your face?

17. **[HOLDING BACK]** Is there something personal about your history or family that you have deliberately avoided telling the rest of the party?

18. **[DISAGREEMENT]** Which companion do you find yourself arguing with most often, even though you still respect their presence in the group?

19. **[A LIFE OWED]** Think of a time a companion saved your life or pulled you out of trouble. Have you ever properly thanked them for it?

20. **[PARTY ROLE]** What do you see as your unofficial role in this group: the protector, the voice of reason, the comic relief, or the wildcard?

III. COMBAT, SCARS & SURVIVAL (21–30)

21. **[FIRST INSTINCT]** When weapons are drawn and initiative is rolled, what is your immediate instinct: charge forward, seek cover, or size up the foe?

22. **[PHYSICAL SCAR]** What physical scar or mark on your body has the most painful story behind it, and do you show it off or keep it hidden?

23. **[CLOSEST CALL]** What was the absolute closest you ever came to dying in battle, and what thought flashed through your head in that moment?

24. **[FAVORED WEAPON]** What weapon, spell, or item in your arsenal feels like an extension of your own body when you wield it?

25. **[BATTLE CRY]** Do you fight with furious shouts, cold grim silence, nervous jokes, or muttered prayers under your breath?

26. **[AFTERMATH]** Right after a deadly combat ends and blood cools, what is the very first thing you do: check your wounds, clean your blade, or check on allies?

27. **[MERCY]** When an enemy drops their weapon and begs for their life, are you inclined to show mercy, or do you finish what was started?

28. **[ADRENALINE]** Does the thrill of combat excite you and make you feel alive, or is fighting a grim, exhausting chore you endure to survive?

29. **[A LOST FOE]** Is there an enemy you killed whose face still haunts your memories, or do you sleep soundly regardless of body count?

30. **[SIGNATURE TRICK]** What is your signature flourish, tactical trick, or stylistic move that your companions have seen you pull off in fights?

IV. FOOD, DRINK & CITY TAVERNS (31–40)

31. **[GO-TO TAVERN]** When you arrive in a new district, what kind of tavern do you look for: a loud, bustling taproom, a quiet inn, or a shady dive?

32. **[FAVORITE DRINK]** What is your character's drink of choice when unwinding: dark bitter stout, sweet mead, burning spirits, or plain cider?

33. **[WORST ROAD MEAL]** What is the most disgusting, burnt, or questionable meal you've choked down on the road just to keep from starving?

34. **[THE COOK]** Can your character actually cook decent food, or would the party actively mutiny if you were put in charge of the stew pot?

35. **[COMFORT FOOD]** What simple, hearty dish reminds you of home and warmth whenever you are cold, battered, and homesick?

36. **[A GRAND FEAST]** If someone gave you a bag of gold and said 'eat like royalty tonight,' what extravagant meal would you order?

37. **[TAVERN BEHAVIOR]** After having three strong drinks, what kind of drunk are you: loud and friendly, brooding and quiet, emotional, or looking for a fight?

38. **[GAMBLING]** Do you enjoy playing dice or card games in smoky taverns, or do you know better than to gamble your hard-earned copper?

39. **[RATION SHARING]** If travel rations were cut in half due to snow or lockdown, would you quietly share your portion, or protect your share?

40. **[A TOAST]** When raising a tankard with your companions after surviving another day, what is your standard, heartfelt toast?

V. COLD, SHADOWS & STREET LIFE (41–50)

41. **[THE COLD]** How does your character cope with the bitter city chill: heavy woolen cloaks, thick furs, layers of leather, or toughing it out?

42. **[WALKING IN DARKNESS]** In a city wrapped in eternal twilight, do you feel comfortable moving through dark alleys, or do you always seek lantern light?

43. **[CITY WATCH]** When you hear heavy boots of a guard patrol stomping down the street, is your first instinct to nod casually, or step into an alley?

44. **[STREET SMART]** What street trick or survival rule—like hiding coin in your boot or watching rooftops—has kept you safe in rough quarters?

45. **[THE SCENT OF THE CITY]** What smell of Varenhold do you notice most when stepping outdoors: chimney soot, muddy canals, wet wool, or roasting meat?

46. **[A NARROW ESCAPE]** Have you ever had to sprint for your life through winding cobblestone alleys or over slick rooftops? Who was chasing you?

47. **[STREET URCHINS]** When a ragged kid tries to pick your pocket or begs for scraps, do you slap their hand away, give them coin, or offer advice?

48. **[SLICK COBBLES]** Have you ever taken an embarrassing spill on icy cobblestones or slippery canal docks? Did anyone see you do it?

49. **[A QUIET CORNER]** Where in the crowded, noisy city do you go when you need an hour of total peace and quiet to gather your thoughts?

50. **[BRIDGES & WATER]** How do you feel about the dark, murky canal waters: completely unfazed, or secretly uncomfortable around deep, cold water?

VI. PAST, FAMILY & MENTORS (51–60)

51. **[THE MENTOR]** Who taught you your most important skill or trade, and what is one memorable piece of advice they drilled into your head?

52. **[FAMILY LEGACY]** What did your family or guardians think of your choice to live the dangerous life of an adventurer?

53. **[CHILDHOOD BEST FRIEND]** Who was your closest friend when you were growing up, and do you have any idea what became of them?

54. **[A PRIZED KEEPSAKE]** What physical item from your past do you still carry with you everywhere, and why does it mean so much to you?

55. **[CHILDHOOD MISCHIEF]** What was the stupidest, most daring piece of trouble you got into as a kid that almost got you caught?

56. **[THE DEPARTURE]** Think back to the day you left home or started wandering. What was the last thing you saw or heard as you walked away?

57. **[UNFINISHED BUSINESS]** Is there someone from your past that you desperately need to see again, whether to reconcile, apologize, or settle a score?

58. **[AN EARLY TRADE]** Before taking up arms or spellcraft, did you have an ordinary job or apprenticeship: blacksmith, courier, farmer, scribe?

59. **[A PARENT'S VOICE]** When your conscience speaks to you in a difficult moment, does it sound like your own voice, or the voice of a parent or teacher?

60. **[HOMESICKNESS]** What is one specific thing about your hometown or early life that you miss far more than you ever thought you would?

VII. SECRETS, FLAWS & WEAKNESSES (61–70)

61. **[THE BAD HABIT]** What is a minor vice or bad habit your character indulges in: smoking a pipe, biting nails, cursing loudly, or hoarding shiny junk?

62. **[THE LIE]** What is a lie you told a companion or stranger that they completely believed, and do you feel guilty about it?

63. **[TEMPTATION]** What temptation is hardest for you to resist: rare magic, a mountain of gold, good wine, a thrilling challenge, or revenge?

64. **[A DEEP REGRET]** If you had the power to turn back time and undo one single mistake you made in your past, what moment would you change?

65. **[BLIND SPOT]** What is a personal flaw that you know you have—stubbornness, arrogance, quick temper, or paranoia—that gets you into trouble?

66. **[SECRET FEAR]** Beyond monsters and dying, what is your character secretly terrified of: being abandoned, going blind, losing control, or poverty?

67. **[OVERSTEPPING]** Have you ever pushed someone too far in an argument or fight and immediately realized you crossed a line?

68. **[A BROKEN PROMISE]** Is there a promise you made to someone that you broke, and does the memory of that broken vow still bother your sleep?

69. **[VANITY]** What small aspect of your appearance or gear are you secretly vain about: your hair, your cloak, your boots, or your weapon's sheen?

70. **[VULNERABILITY]** What does your character look like when they are completely emotionally overwhelmed? Do you shut down, cry, or lash out in anger?

VIII. FAITH, LUCK & SUPERSTITIONS (71–80)

71. **[A QUIET PRAYER]** Do you pray to a specific deity, whisper to general gods of luck and travel, or rely purely on your own two hands?

72. **[GOOD LUCK CHARM]** Do you carry a lucky coin, a worn feather, a knotted cord, or a carved token that you believe keeps bad luck away?

73. **[PRE-BATTLE RITUAL]** What small superstition do you observe before kicking in a door or entering a dangerous crypt: tapping iron, kissing a token, checking boots?

74. **[OMEN]** What everyday occurrence do you consider a sign of bad luck: a raven landing near you, an overturned salt cellar, or a flickering lamp?

75. **[FATE VS CHOICE]** Do you believe your destiny has already been written by the gods, or that every person carves their own path with their choices?

76. **[HOLY PLACES]** When you step into a temple or sacred shrine, do you feel a sense of peaceful reverence, or an awkward desire to leave quickly?

77. **[A BLESSING GIVEN]** Have you ever offered an honest prayer or blessing for someone else's safety, and who was it for?

78. **[MIRACLES]** Have you ever witnessed something so miraculous or inexplicable that it fundamentally shook what you believe about the world?

79. **[CYNICISM]** When a holy priest or preacher promises that 'the gods have a plan for you,' do you find comfort in that, or roll your eyes?

80. **[THE FINAL REST]** When your adventuring days are finally over, where in the world would you want your bones to be laid to rest?

IX. HUMOR, QUIRKS & CAMP LIFE (81–90)

81. **[WEIRD BACKPACK ITEM]** What is an unusual, sentimental, or totally non-combat item you stubbornly carry in your backpack at all times?

82. **[A GENUINE LAUGH]** When was the last time something was so funny that you laughed until your ribs hurt, and who was there with you?

83. **[A BOAST]** What is an outrageous boast or exaggerated story about yourself that you like to tell around a tavern table?

84. **[CAMP DUTY]** Which camp chore do you secretly hate doing the most: gathering firewood, skinning game, washing pots, or standing first watch?

85. **[NICKNAMES]** Does your character have an embarrassing childhood nickname, or an alias you used when you got into trouble?

86. **[MUSIC & SONG]** Can your character sing, hum a decent tune, or play an instrument, or are you aggressively tone-deaf?

87. **[ANIMALS]** How do you react to street dogs, stray cats, or horses: do you immediately try to pet them, or ignore them completely?

88. **[GEAR MAINTENANCE]** Are you obsessive about sharpening your weapons and oiling your leather every evening, or do you clean gear only when forced?

89. **[A PECULIAR QUIRK]** What is an odd, unique habit or mannerism of yours: cracking knuckles, speaking with hands, pacing back and forth?

90. **[LIFTING SPIRITS]** When the party is battered, freezing, and miserable, what is your way of trying to cut the tension or raise morale?

X. THE CLIMAX, LEGACY & TOMORROW (91–100)

91. **[WHY YOU FIGHT]** When you are bruised, freezing, and facing terrible odds today, what core belief or person is driving you to keep standing?

92. **[IF TOMORROW COMES]** If the party succeeds and you survive this final crisis, what is the very first thing you want to do with your newfound freedom?

93. **[THE DREAM LIFE]** Imagine a peaceful life without blood, monsters, and fear. What trade would you practice, and what would your home look like?

94. **[LAST WORDS]** If your character falls in battle today, what is one final message or confession you would want passed to your companions?

95. **[WHAT YOU'LL MISS]** When this adventure is over and the party eventually goes their separate ways, what will you miss most about travelling together?

96. **[THE LINE YOU WON'T CROSS]** No matter how desperate the stakes get in the final hour, what is one line you swear your character will never cross?

97. **[A PROMISE MADE]** What solemn promise have you made to a companion, a friend, or yourself that you intend to fulfill before the sun rises?

98. **[HOW YOU WANT TO BE REMEMBERED]** Fifty years from now, when bards or old soldiers speak your name in taverns, what do you hope they say about you?

99. **[FACING THE CLIMAX]** Looking at your companions right now before walking into the final confrontation, what do you feel: dread, calm resolve, or fierce pride?

100. **[THE PRICE OF DAWN]** Every victory has a cost—blood, sweat, sacrifice, or lost innocence. Looking back on the whole journey, was it worth the price?